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Loren Lockwood
HRRP National Coordinator

MESSAGE FROM THE NATIONAL COORDINATOR

The 100th edition of the HRRP bulletin is a significant milestone for HRRP. The bulletin has been a key product of the platform since it was launched at the end of October 2016 and it has been great to see it continuously improving and growing since then.

It is used by a wide range of actors, both in Nepal and globally, and will be a useful reference for years to come. The amount of information, links, reports, lessons, and case studies contained in each edition is a valuable resource for the current recovery and future responses.

This milestone comes just as phase 3 of HRRP was set to end. However, we are pleased to share that DFID and CRS will be generously continuing to provide financial support so that this phase of the platform can be extended until the end of July 2019. Plans are being developed for a fourth phase of the platform beyond this also.

I would like to give a special thanks to DFID and CRS for their support to date, and the support to extend the platform's current function through this building season. I would also like to thank Plan International and Oxfam for the financial support extended by them, and the implementation support from NSET and Caritas Nepal.

HRRP will be going through some restructuring in the coming months to align with the reduction of available funds. As part of this some activities will be prioritized and some reduced. The HRRP bulletins will be sent out monthly instead of every two weeks. The monthly bulletin will be sent out on the second Monday of every month, so the next bulletin will be sent on 11 March.

Putting together the bulletin to send out every week until April 2018, and then every two weeks has been a huge task for the HRRP team and all the contributors from other organisations that have been involved. It has been a hugely rewarding task though, with the bulletin documenting progress and highlights under the housing reconstruction. We hope that you enjoy the 100th edition of the bulletin, and that you have enjoyed the previous 99 editions, and look forward to continuing to work together during the HRRP3 extension period.

I would sincerely like to thank all the staff of the HRRP for their continued commitment, hard work and innovation. I am consistently impressed by the work that is done by the team, and the bulletin is a good example if that.

Lastly, I would like to thank all of the HRRP partners and over 3,500 subscribers to the bulletin for your input and support over the years. As we are not an organization, but a platform, it is you that make the platform successful. Thank you!

‘What has the impact of the bulletin been on the housing reconstruction?’

HRRP asked reconstruction actors to share their thoughts on the impact of the bulletin on the housing reconstruction and we are pleased to share the following selection of responses.

“I wish to congratulate the HRRP family on hitting the 100th edition of the HRRP bulletin. Each issue has been full of facts, figures, and accurate information. Its first glance always gives me a sense of success and achievement. The bulletin is serving as a ready-made handy reference. The presentation of the information authenticates the responsible professionalism and readers-friendly outlook. No doubt, the bulletin has provided a diamond opportunity for the NRA to mobilise its limited time, resources and institutional expertise to further catalyse reconstruction and recovery works on the ground.”

Dr. Bishnu B. Bhandari
Executive Member, NRA

“The HRRP Bulletin helps me stay on top of information related to reconstruction and the social changes surrounding it. The bulletin helps me understand the various dimensions of engagement between stakeholders and "beneficiaries" at different levels. This kind of regular flow of information really helps me stay updated and helps my work. I am certain the bulletin is useful for all HRRP members and many beyond. I sincerely hope this fabulous endeavour of HRRP continues as our country phases into more collaborative concerted efforts towards Disaster Risk Reduction.”

Archana Tamang
Gender Equality and Social Inclusion (GESI) Advisor, NRA

“I have been working with BBC Media Action as a Radio Mentor/Trainer since 2016. HRRP's Bulletin is very informative to me to learn about the reconstruction scenario across the earthquake affected districts. This information has helped me while providing mentoring support to the partner radio stations.”

Bhawana Gurung
Radio Mentor/Trainer, BBC Media Action, Nepal

“HRRP has been providing different types of support for reconstruction such as communications, providing a platform to resolve technical issues with different stakeholders, conducting different pieces of research, coordinating the different activities of I/NGOs, and many other activities. I am very happy on the publication of the 100th issue of HRRP bulletin. The bulletin supports NRA to disseminate its policies, activities and reconstruction updates. I look forward to continuing to work with HRRP to support reconstruction progress.”

Manohar Ghimire
Section Chief, MIS section & Deputy Spokesperson, NRA

“I have been working with the Shelter Cluster and HRRP since 2015 right after the earthquake. Our team has implemented the Community Mobilisation Program in our target area of Gorkha and Sindhupalchok and achieved

good housing reconstruction progress. HRRP as a platform has given us an opportunity to share our experience and we hope that these good practices could be helpful to other earthquake affected area. We are looking forward to completing housing reconstruction together with HRRP.”

Tomoki Miyano

Team Leader, TPIS-ERP (JICA Grant Aid Project)/EHRP (JICA Loan Project)

“Going through the HRRP Bulletin gives me a sense of well-structured compiled information needs fulfilled regarding reconstruction. This bulletin should put effort to include tiniest of the tiniest initiatives on reconstruction with brief analysis”.

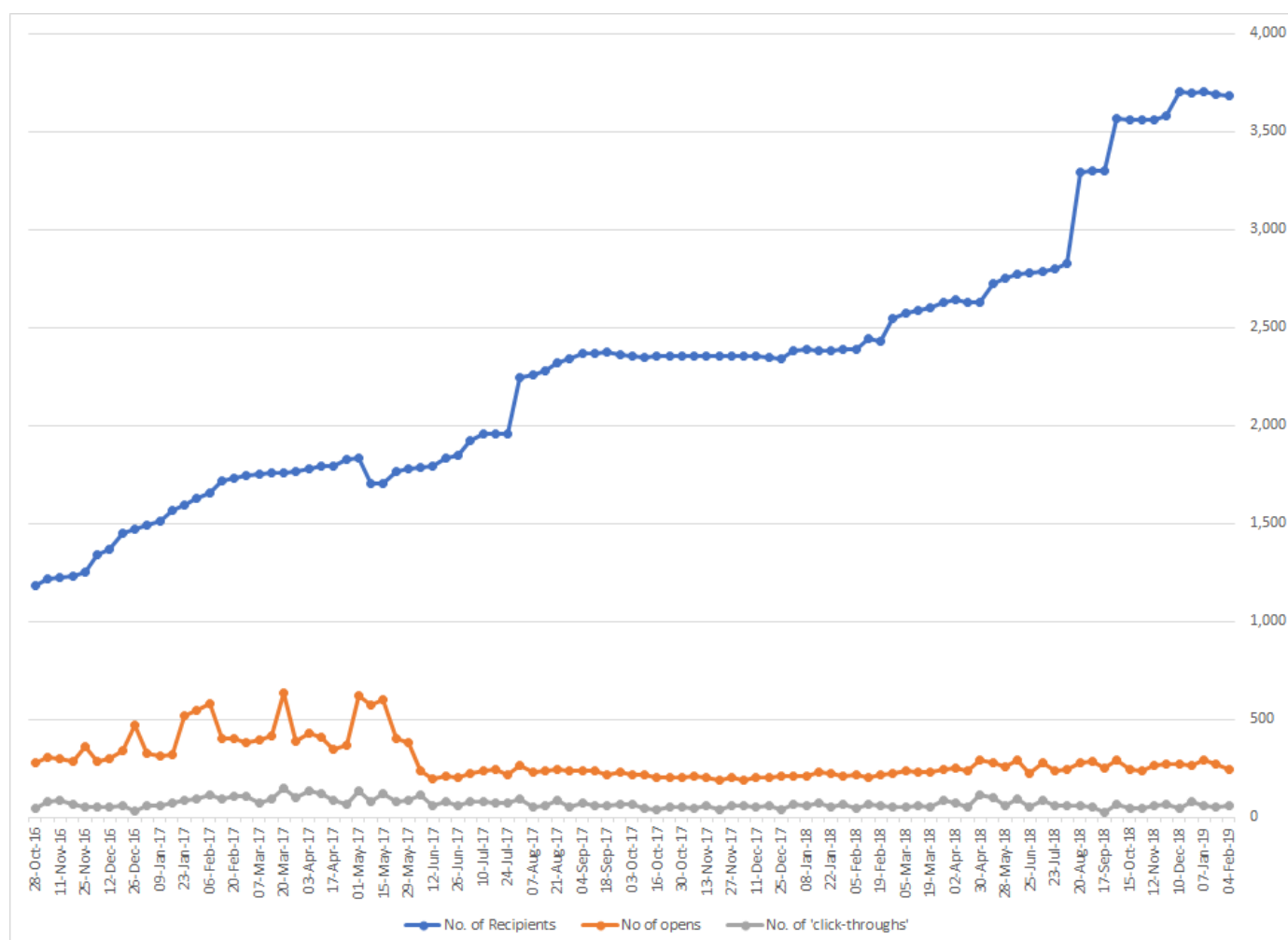
Subas Chandra Shiwakoti

Deputy Financial Comptroller General, Financial Comptroller General Office, Ministry of Finance

“I have been working with HRRP immediately after my nomination at the National Reconstruction Authority (NRA) in January 2016. As a lead for rural housing sector, I worked with HRRP for avoiding overlapping and gaps of NGO's presence across the earthquake impacted districts. Various HRRP infographics were instrumental for shaping some of the NRA policies. We relied on HRRP information system for assessing field situation. HRRP organised periodic shelter meetings which helped to enhance coordination, to develop appropriate policies and to implement reconstruction works effectively. Altogether, HRRP has remained a really useful resource for NRA.”

Dr. Chandra Bahadur Shrestha

Executive Member, NRA



Bulletin readership numbers since the first bulletin was sent out on 28 October 2016 up to the 99th edition on 4 February 2019.

Who subscribes to the HRRP mailing list?

Category	Number of Subscribers	% of Total
Partner Organisations	1,589	31.9%
Other government agencies	1,472	29.6%
District / municipal government offices	837	16.8%
NRA – Central Level	284	5.7%
Journalists / media	269	5.4%
GMALI CLPIU & DLPIU	212	4.3%
Building DLPIU	119	2.4%
NRA – District Level	104	2.1%
Building CLPIU	71	1.4%
Private sector	22	0.4%
Total	4,979	

Bulletin Trends







Featured Technical Staff Person



Binita Shrestha
Architect, Dhulikhel-9, Kavre

This week's featured technical staff person is Binita Shrestha, originally from Chitwan, who was working as an architect in Bhaktapur Municipality before the 2015 earthquake.

Binita joined the NRA in July 2016 as she wanted to support the reconstruction and was deployed to Chatrabaj VDC, now Namobuddha Municipality-9. Binita was then transferred to Dhulikhel Municipality-9 and has been working there since.

Binita shares an overview of her experience, which has been positive, but also shares her fears that in the name of safer construction, traditional architecture and technology will be lost.

Highlights

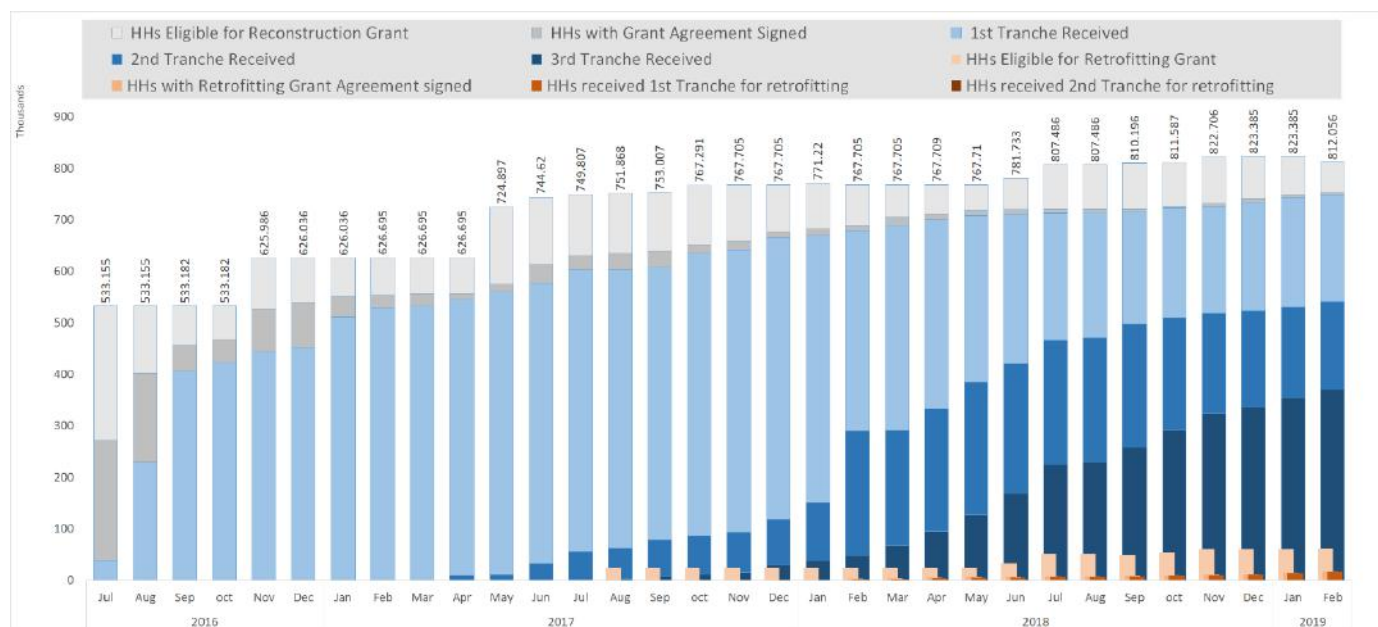
- [Round Table Discussion on Support to Vulnerable Households, 19 February, 1-4 PM, Bougainvillea, Tripureshor](#)
 - [Launch of a new ALNAP lessons paper on earthquake response, 13 February](#). The paper was launched in both [English](#) and [Nepali](#)
 - [Causes Behind Delays in Housing Reconstruction Progress in the Earthquake Housing Reconstruction Programme \(EHRP\), A Study of Rural Municipalities of Lalitpur, NRA Monitoring and Evaluation Specialist for Lalitpur, Okhaldhunga, and Rasuwa](#)
 - [Case Study: Rasuwa, Gosaikunda RM, Ward No. 2, Timure](#)
 - Initial results from the fourth round of the HRRP partner satisfaction survey
 - In Ward 1 Khiidemba Rural Municipality, Okhaldhunga, 40 people whose houses were non-compliant (out of a total of 45 non-compliant houses) chose to construct new two room houses rather than applying correction measures to the non-compliant houses.
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National Updates

NRA, CLPIU GMALI and Building, Grant Disbursement Data, as of 18 February:

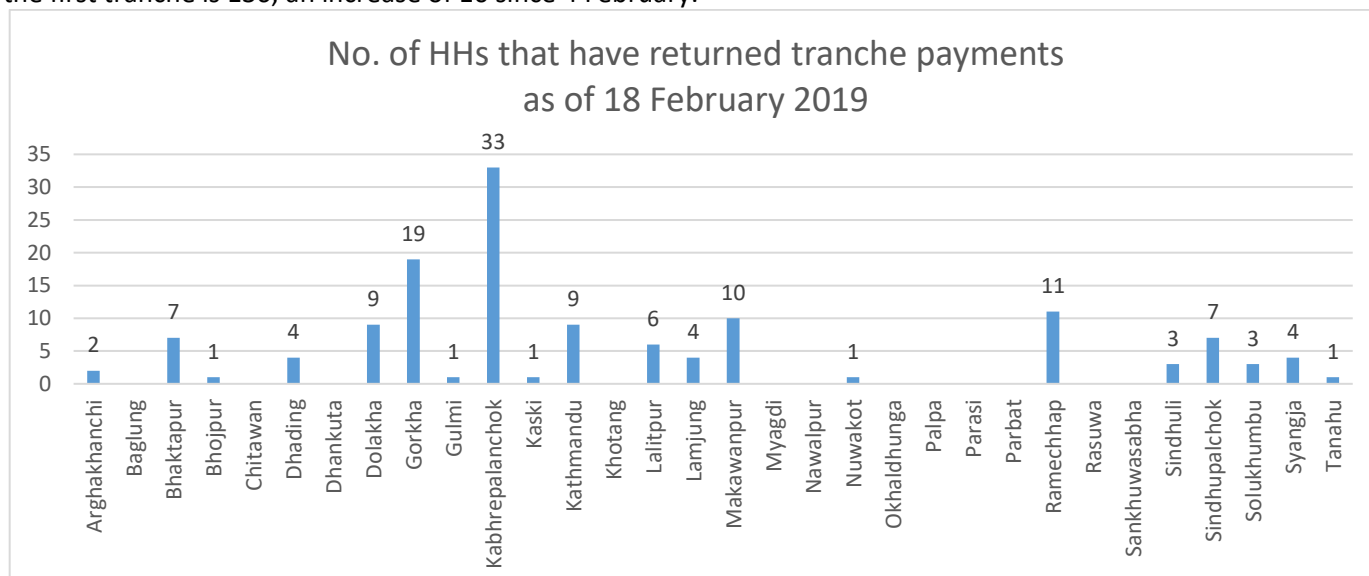
Reconstruction Grant	21 January	4 February	18 February
Total No. Eligible HHs	811,154*	811,221*	812,056
HHs Enrolled	749,783	751,790	754,204
HHs Received 1 st Tranche	744,050	746,853	749,296
HHs Applied for 2 nd Tranche	549,549	557,904	564,639
HHs Received 2 nd Tranche	531,210	536,030	541,774
Non-compliant at 2 nd Tranche	4,673	4,713	4,728
HHs Applied for 3 rd Tranche	386,136	395,255	402,852
HHs Received 3 rd Tranche	354,396	363,640	371,279
Non-compliant at 3 rd Tranche	2,431	2,708	2,931
Houses Completed	350,762	365,831	370,250
HHs with Completion Certificate	4,560	4,462	5,964
Retrofit Grant	21 January	4 February	18 February
Total No. Eligible HHs	61,591	61,836	61,860
HHs Enrolled	15,462	16,695	17,198
HHs Received 1 st Tranche	14,148	15,672	16,186
HHs Received 2 nd Tranche	20	23	27

*the total number of households eligible for the GoN housing reconstruction grant has decreased because there had been an error in the numbers reported from Sindhuli and this has now been corrected.



Progress with the disbursement of the GoN housing reconstruction and retrofit grants based on NRA, GMALI CLPIU, and Building CLPIU data from July 2016 to 18 February 2019.

Tracking Return of First Tranche: numbers are based on data collected by HRRP District Coordination Teams (DCTs) through the GMALI DLPIU offices. As of 18 February, the total number of households that have returned the first tranche is 136, an increase of 10 since 4 February.



HRRP Partner Satisfaction Survey Round 4, Initial Findings: huge thanks to the 230 respondents to the survey (88% working at district level and 12% working at national level), we really appreciate you taking the time to share your suggestions and feedback to help the platform improve. Some initial survey findings are as follows:

- Of the respondents who read the HRRP bulletin, 35% find it very useful (+4% from PSS3), 59% find it useful (+3% from PSS3), and 6% find it somewhat useful (-5% from PSS3).
- 61% respondents (-9% from PSS3) rated HRRP updates on reconstruction efforts as accurate, 22% rated as very accurate (+7% from PSS3), and 16% rated as somewhat accurate (+2% from PSS3).
- 75% of respondents (+5% from PSS3) said that they have used HRRP products or website resources at least once in the past 4 months.
- 48% of respondents have used HRRP research products (data and / or reports).
- 47% of respondents (-14% from PSS3) reported that they or their organisation had made changes to their activities or programme(s) based on information shared and / or discussions at HRRP district level events (meetings, orientations, trainings, or workshops).
- 98% of respondents (-1% from PSS3) agree that HRRP technical information and guidance is easy to access, 90% agree that it is well researched (+4% from PSS3), and 94% agree that it is relevant to their work (-2% from PSS3).
- 83% respondents (+1% from PSS3) agree that HRRP has contributed to reducing gaps and preventing duplication in reconstruction efforts, 16% remained neutral, and 2% disagree (-2% from PSS3) with the statement.
- 70% respondents (+10% from PSS3) agree that HRRP has supported strengthening of emergency preparedness and response, 26% remained neutral, and 3% disagree (-5% from PSS3) with the statement.
- 59% respondents (+15% from PSS3) agree that HRRP has promoted and mainstreamed Gender Equality and Social Inclusion (GESI) in reconstruction work, 33% remained neutral, and 8% disagree (-14% from PSS3) with the statement. This represents good progress between PSS3 and PSS4 results, but HRRP still has a lot opportunity and space to further promote GESI in reconstruction work.

A full report on the survey results will be shared soon. If you have any questions about the partner satisfaction survey please feel free to contact Rupa Pandey, HRRP MEAL Coordinator, meal@hrrpnepal.org.

Notice, Changes to Deadlines & Revisions to Grant Disbursement Procedures for Private Houses Destroyed by the Earthquake, 14 February: this notice shared some important updates which are potentially set to have a very positive impact on the housing reconstruction. The deadline for the disbursement of the first tranche has been extended to 16 July 2019 and the deadlines for the disbursement of the second and third tranches have been removed. The revisions to the grant disbursement procedures include provisions for people that were living in a house owned by another person, and who become homeless as a result of damage caused to that house, to be eligible to receive the housing reconstruction grant under three options depending on agreement with the house owner, whether they have other land or not, etc. In historical settlements households will be eligible to receive an additional 50,000 NPRs if they rebuild using traditional architecture. People whose houses are damaged as a result of the demolition of attached earthquake damaged houses can now also be listed as eligible for the housing reconstruction grant.

Launch of a new ALNAP lessons paper on earthquake response, 13 February: ALNAP (Active Learning Network for Accountability and Performance in Humanitarian Action) is a network of humanitarian organisations focused on learning. ALNAP lessons papers gather learning from responses to previous crises in order to inform response to future crises. ALNAP recently updated the methodology used to produce these sorts of papers in order to improve the rigour and transparency of the method. The first lessons paper to use this new methodology focuses on lessons around earthquake response and captures learning from earthquake response worldwide over the past decade, including the 2015 Nepal earthquake response. The paper was launched, in both [English](#) and [Nepali](#), at an event on 13 February at Dhokaima Café. Videos from the event are available on the HRRP YouTube channel [here](#).

Affordable Housing in Nepali Cities, 8 February: an interaction programme on 'Affordable housing in Nepali cities' was organised by the DFID funded Community-led Infrastructure Financing Facility (CLIFF) in collaboration with Reall, Sewa, and Lumanti on 8 February at the DFID office in Kathmandu. CLIFF has been supporting partners to develop pilot models for affordable housing provision in Nepal, and across Africa and Asia as access to finance has been the most critical issue in housing particularly in rapidly urbanising countries like Nepal. Reall, Sewa, and Lumanti shared their experience in convening stakeholders to develop projects that address this critical need in Nepal's cities. There were two framing presentations. The first one was made by Rubbina Karruna, Cities Adviser, DFID UK on 'why is affordable housing critical to inclusive and resilient urban development?' and the other was by Ian Shapiro, CEO of Reall, on the challenges and opportunities of affordable housing provision followed by two case studies. Sewa presented the case study of Kohalpur Housing Project, a collaborative effort of the local government and community (partnership with Municipality model). Lumanti talked about two models; the cooperative model where access to finance was through cooperative and partnership with bank model bank provides subsidized loan as one of their CSR initiatives. Finally, the program ended with discussion on key actions / way forward to enable affordable housing to be delivered at scale across Nepali cities after group work. For more information, please contact Eleanor Bainbridge, e-bainbridge@dfid.gov.uk.

Working Together for Disaster Relief - How can the private sector better work with the humanitarian sector in pre- and post-disaster reconstruction and development to reinforce local ownership and support localisation?, BRE Event, 8 February, UK: the private and humanitarian sectors met to discuss on how to work together to support and develop local capacity for the longer term sustainability and resilience. Various agencies and initiatives presented and discussed various issues related to collaboration between humanitarian, government, academic, and private partners. Experiences in Nepal on localisation and collaboration with private sector were presented at the event by following partners in person or remotely:

- [Humanitarian and private sector collaboration: lessons from the response to the Nepal Earthquake 2015, Shuva Sharma, Scott Wilson Nepal](#)
- [Strengthening supply chain of construction materials in earthquake-affected districts of Nepal, Dr Sujan Piya, Practical Action Nepal](#)
- [Post-Earthquake Reconstruction of Energy-efficient, environment-friendly and structurally-resilient brick kilns, Usha Manandhar, MinErgy Nepal](#)

In March, a one-day follow up event will be held in Nepal to bring together the private and humanitarian sectors to meet and consider how to work together to support and develop local capacity for longer term sustainability and

resilience specifically in the Nepal context. This event is being organised by HRRP's private sector working group and more details will be shared soon. For more information, and / or to join the private sector working group, please contact Minar Thapa Magar, HRRP Deputy National Coordinator, minar@hrrpnepal.org.

Community Energy Resilience and Electricity Systems in South Asia Workshop, 11 February: the objective of the workshop was to identify research opportunities to increase community energy resilience in on-grid, mini-grid, and stand-alone electricity systems. The meeting was attended by representative from organisations working on off-grid and alternative electricity generation to support households that are not connected to the national grid system. The organisations represented included SELCO India, IDCOL Bangladesh, ICIMOD, Practical Action, NSET, and Social Science Baha as well as the Alternative Energy Promotion Centre (AEPC) representing the GoN side. The meeting mostly focused on discussing potential research areas in disaster response and preparedness in terms of energy resilience of the community and the most effective methods of providing energy. The presenters focused on making the energy supply system in such a way that it undergoes minimum damage during the time of disaster and different social, climate, and environmental aspects to be considered during the development of the electricity system designing and installation. The presenters highlighted the need of the energy services to the most vulnerable communities that are more susceptible to the disaster.

Cash Coordination Group Meeting, 15 February: the meeting was held in the MoFAGA (Ministry of Federal Affairs and General Administration) meeting hall and was chaired by Mr. Suresh Adhikari, MoFAGA Joint Secretary and unit head of the local bodies capacity development unit. Participants discussed the issues and challenges they have faced during the previous year due to the lack of the proper guidelines on cash transfer. Most of the implementing agencies were following their own transfer mechanism and policy in the field which limited the synergy in the cash support to the disaster affected community during the emergency. Based on the learning of the past year and need for the defined role and responsibility for the CCG, the ToR of the CCG was presented in the meeting followed with the comments and recommendations from the participants for the necessary revision and updates. The meeting decided to revise the TOR based on the comments received and share accordingly. The meeting also agreed on developing the cash and voucher transfer guideline/framework that would guide the agencies working in the cash for all kinds of CTP in future. Nepal Red Cross Society was selected as the co-Chair of CCG based on their experience on CTP program and fund mobilisation capacity including the coordination between different Red cross. At the end of the meeting the chair stressed the need for any guidelines developed to align with the prevailing law and policy. He also addressed the need and importance of the data/inventory of the affected people which will help them to be included in the social protection system. The engagement of the private sector and capacity enhancement of the local bodies was also presented during the meeting. Finally, the chair concluded the meeting with his remarks on the importance of the close coordination among GoN, Private Sector, and implementing partner agencies in supporting the disaster affected population.

District & Municipal Updates

Interaction workshops between Banks & Financial Institutions (BFIs) and Small and Micro Entrepreneurs (SMEs) in the construction sector, Nuwakot and Dhading, January 2019: these workshops took place during the last week of January and were supported by the DFID-Funded Purnima project, implemented by Mott MacDonald. The workshops were organised to facilitate SMEs to access loans for business expansion. SMEs presented their business plan, which Purnima helped them to prepare, in the workshop. BFIs, happy to see the proper business plans which is rare among the SMEs in Nepal, invited the SMEs to their respective bank for the loan and offered all the support accessing the loan. They also explained about the loan products they have on offer and the process to apply for the loan. The workshops were helpful in reducing the communication gap between the BFIs and SMEs. Forty-two SMEs who received the business development training from Purnima in mid-December 2018 and 12 BFIs of different categories participated in the workshops.



Srijana Neupane pitching her business plan to the BFIs.

HRRP District and Municipal Coordination Meetings, 18 – 31 Jan 2019: during this period a district coordination meeting took place in Kavrepalanchok (11 February). Municipal level meetings took place in Bethanchok Rural Municipality, Kavrepalanchok (1 February), Dhulikhel Municipality, Kavrepalanchok (12 – 14 February), Manthali Municipality, Ramechhap (4 February), Jugul Rural Municipality, Sindhupalchok (6 - 8 February), Khijidemba Rural Municipality, Okhaldhunga (7 – 9 February), Palungtar Municipality, Gorkha (11 February), Shankarapur Municipality, Kathmandu (11 February), and Lalitpur Metropolitan City, Lalitpur (14 February). Some of the highlights from these meetings include:

- In **Kavrepalanchok**, 48,065 files have been forwarded for second tranche and 36,094 files have been forwarded for third tranche. So far, 32 people have returned the first tranche of the GoN housing reconstruction grant. Concerns were raised about the lack progress on the final inspection and distribution of the completion certificates in the district. Technical persons were requested to carry out the final inspection process for the distribution of the completion certificate, fill out Annex 17 and submit to DLPIU. Satisfactory progress was noted in school reconstruction. Retention of technical persons in work place was a major challenge as observed by DLPIU.
- **Wards 4 and 6, Bethanchok Rural Municipality, Kavrepalanchok:** retrofitting is the major challenge in both the wards. Though retrofitting awareness programmes have been conducted in both wards, people are still reluctant to retrofit their houses. **In Ward 4**, out of 74 households eligible for the retrofit grant, 3 have enrolled and none have withdrawn the first tranche from their accounts and none have moved forward with retrofitting either. The ward is collecting applications from people willing to switch from retrofit to full reconstruction beneficiaries. There are also few landless issues in the ward. **In Ward 6**, there are a total of 239 people eligible for the retrofit grant and of these 44 have received the first tranche and none have retrofitted their house. Almost everyone wants to build a new house but they also do not want to demolish the pre-earthquake house. Mass orientation and video awareness on retrofitting too have been conducted multiple times by UNOPS. The major reason for the continued reluctance to retrofit is the high transportation cost for cement and steel. The timber available in the ward is soft wood which cannot be used for retrofitting, so the only option is using cement. The Ward Chief along with UNOPS team is planning to do a demo retrofit on his own damaged house where the material will be provided by the

home owner and technical support will be provided by UNOPS team but there is only a faint hope that other beneficiaries will be motivated through the demo.



The house of the Ward Chief of MahankalChaur, Ward 6, Bethanchok Rural Municipality which has been proposed for a retrofit demo to try to encourage uptake of retrofitting in the area.

- **Wards 9, 10, 11, 12, Dhulikhel Municipality, Kavrepalanchok:** In **Ward 9**, most people who have yet to enroll have land issues. Compulsory municipal building permit also has discouraged people from rebuilding. The major issue in the ward is that the technical persons deployed from NRA need to prepare all the site plans and location plans of the beneficiaries who are constructing houses using the DUDBC models. Most of the houses being constructed are load bearing structures with a very few RCC houses. Whilst the technical persons need to engage in drawing preparation, the inspection progress is lower. None of the houses have had the final inspection or received the completion certificate. In **Ward 10**, the major issue is the coordination gap with the municipal engineers. There are some cases where the municipal drawings do not comply with the building codes and hence the structures are non-compliant. Even though the non-compliances have been addressed by the DSE, people are reluctant to apply the corrections. As per the request from the ward, one day field visit of DSE was scheduled to oversee five major non-compliances of the ward. In **Ward 11**, only 6 of the structures are non-compliant and the files have been forwarded for analysis to the DSE. In **Ward 12**, the rate of reconstruction is comparatively low because most of the people eligible for the grant have temporarily migrated to Banepa and Kathmandu. During the visit, a Saudi Arabian team was briefed about the tranche distribution process by the Ward Chief which was followed by interactions with people reconstructing their homes
- In **Ward 8, Manthali Municipality, Ramechhap**, it was reported that the reconstruction is progressing well. There are only two technical staff in the ward. Most non-compliant cases are in stone and mud mortar masonry houses where bands have been incorrectly placed or bands have not been included at all. There are some houses built before the deployment of technical staff in the field that are non-compliant. Scott Wilson is providing socio technical assistance in the ward.
- In **Wards 4 and 5, Jugal Rural Municipality, Sindhupalchok**, the main concern raised was on resurvey and verification where many people have been left out as the resurvey team did not reach everywhere. The Ward Chairperson was not clear if these people should again appeal for grievance or the earlier list works is now fixed as the eligible list. The cost of raw materials is soaring in the village which is driving up the cost of reconstruction. According to the Ward Chairperson, 1 Paathi of sand costs 40 NPRs in the village.
- In **Jugal Rural Municipality, Sindhupalchok**, the main concerns were regarding the absence of technical persons in the ward and the increase in non-compliance cases. All ward Chiefs were requested to maintain

an attendance sheet of technical persons and take necessary action if they are absent frequently. There are people who have constructed up to plinth level and are eligible for the second tranche, but they missed the NRA tranche deadline, so the engineers are confused and unsure if the files can be forwarded to DLPIU or not. It was reported that the reconstruction in the municipality is almost coming an end, but the process has not started for final inspections and distribution of completion certificates. Technical persons have been requested to start the final inspection.

- In **Ward 1 Khiidemba Rural Municipality, Okhaldhunga**, it was reported that people eligible for the retrofit grant are not willing to retrofit their houses and would like to be on the list for the full reconstruction grant. Some people who were left in the initial survey are waiting for the resurvey but do not have any information on it. Engineers mentioned that 45 people whose houses were non-compliant were suggested for the correction measures. But 40 of them constructed new two room houses rather than applying correction measures to the non-compliant houses.
- In **Khiidemba Rural Municipality, Okhaldhunga**, the municipal engineer reported that in wards 5 and 6 there are 14 non-compliant houses. These houses were built before the arrival of the technical persons in the field. In case of non-compliant houses built after the arrival of technical persons, people are reluctant to apply correction measures which is the main challenge. Non-compliant houses corrected have been forwarded by engineers to DLPIU, but those houses have not been approved and this is creating problems for the engineers to encourage application of correction measures in the field. Due to lack of technical persons in the municipalities to inspect the houses, it has been difficult to convert retrofitting beneficiaries to the full reconstruction beneficiaries. Also, internet problem has delayed the CS entry and completion certificate distribution process.
- In **Ward 3, Khiidemba Rural Municipality, Okhaldhunga**, it was reported that there are 7 people that have not received the tranche due to errors in their partnership agreement number. There are some people who did not start reconstruction thinking that their land is in hazard risk areas and not suitable for construction but later they came to know that those lands are not listed in geohazard prone area. Thus, these people are just starting to rebuild.
- In **Palungtar Municipality, Gorkha**, ODRC/UNDP presented the reconstruction status of their supported wards and HRRP presented the reconstruction status of other wards. Discussion focused on the issues related to reconstruction such as delay in payment of tranche by the banks, duplication in beneficiaries, and removal of people from reconstruction beneficiaries list. The Mayor of Palungtar Municipality requested all stakeholders to seriously work to complete the reconstruction work in time. They also requested the Ward Chiefs to follow up with people and encourage them to start reconstruction.
- In **Ward 4, Shankharapur Municipality, Kathmandu**, the dominant housing typologies in the area are hollow concrete blocks, interlocking bricks with CGI sheets, and hybrid structures. Only a few people who have built using hollow concrete blocks have received the second and third tranches. Some people were found to have used stone and cement mortar masonry for the DPC construction. In Ward no. 4 Phedi, the Lutheran World Federation (LWF) have supported reconstruction of a few houses (6 or 7) and a few houses have been rebuilt by Lumanti. These POs provided the GoN housing reconstruction grant of 300,000 NPRs to these households. There are few people in Phedi who are living on Aelani land (Government land) without any legal documents. It was reported that the ward office will collect grievances for the last time from the people who have been missed in the previous round of survey, so they can be included in the reconstruction list.
- In **Lalitpur Metropolitan City (LMC), Lalitpur**, only a few Partner Organisations (POs) are involved in carrying out reconstruction activities in housing and heritage sites. The NRA, in coordination with different agencies like Department of Archaeology, Patan Durbar Square Monument Office, Kathmandu Valley Preservation Trust, and Bungmati Area Reconstruction and Development Committee (BARDEC), is carrying out reconstruction of different heritage sites in various wards of LMC. LMC has strictly requested engineers to follow building bylaws during the housing reconstruction inspection process. The annual council meeting of every ward in LMC agreed to set aside 100,000 NPRs emergency fund for disaster preparedness and response. Similarly, LMC has set aside 5,000,000 NPRs emergency fund for disaster preparedness and response during emergency situations. Different kinds of awareness programmes on disaster preparedness and response are aired through television and radio. Disaster response awareness

programmes are also conducted at community level on a regular basis by LMC. It was reported that during the earthquake, local communities were actively involved in securing the artifacts of culturally important heritage monuments in the world heritage areas of LMC. Inside LMC, 10 traditional settlements are being assessed to regenerate the cultural authenticity during housing reconstruction as well as in reconstruction of heritage monuments; however compact settlements have not been addressed in the process.

- In **Ward 22, Bungmati, Lalitpur Metropolitan City**, there are four POs involved in reconstruction activities: Center for Integrated Urban Development (CIUD) in infrastructure development, Lumanti in social mobilisation, Sabah Nepal in income generation initiatives, and BARDEC looking after regeneration and reconstruction of culturally important heritage monuments of Bungmati area. Currently, NRA in direct coordination with BARDEC is reconstructing Rato Machhindranath temple, with funding from the Government of Sri Lanka. The key challenges of reconstruction highlighted in the ward are related to maintaining the cultural authenticity of heritage areas, addition of extra storeys beyond specifications in the building drawings, disputes over land ownership among multiple beneficiaries, and small parcels of land. There is a lack of proper awareness among the population about building bylaws and minimum requirements and this has impacted the resilience of the reconstructed houses.

[HRRP District Coordination Team Gorkha, Weekly District Report, 1 – 14 Feb 2019](#)



Ward No. 1, Gorkha Municipality, Gorkha: two room, stone masonry mud mortar house with RCC bands. The home owner has received all three tranches of the GoN housing reconstruction grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Kathmandu Valley, Weekly District Report, 1 – 14 Feb 2019



Ward No. 8, Shankarapur Municipality, Kathmandu: single storey, 4 room, brick and cement mortar masonry house. The home owner has received the second tranche of the GoN housing reconstruction grant and is eligible for the third tranche. The home owner was suggested not to add another storey.

HRRP District Coordination Team Kavrepalanchok, Weekly District Report, 1 – 14 Feb 2019



Ward No. 6, Bethanchok Rural Municipality, Kavrepalanchok: stone and mud mortar masonry house. The home owner has received the third tranche of the GoN housing reconstruction grant.

HRRP District Coordination Team Nuwakot, Weekly District Report, 1 – 14 Feb 2019



Ward No. 3, Kharanitaar Rural Municipality, Nuwakot: Cement Stabilised Earth Block (CSEB) houses, built with support from OXFAM. These houses have been constructed as part of an integrated settlement to support the relocation of families who lost their land due to geo-hazards.

HRRP District Coordination Team Okhaldhunga, Weekly District Report, 1 – 14 Feb 2019



Ward No. 2, Khijidemba Rural Municipality, Okhaldhunga: two room, stone and mud mortar masonry house with RCC bands. The home owner has received all three tranches of the GoN housing reconstruction grant. The total cost of construction was 700,000 NPRs.

[HRRP District Coordination Team Sindhuli, Weekly District Report, 1 – 14 Feb 2019](#)



Ward No. 5, Sunkoshi Rural Municipality, Sindhuli: stone and mud mortar masonry house. The home owner, who is elderly and listed as vulnerable, has received the second tranche of the GoN housing reconstruction grant. Mercy Corps provided 50,000 NPRs vulnerable top up and technical support for the construction of the house.

[HRRP District Coordination Team Sindhupalchok, Weekly District Report, 1 – 14 Feb 2019](#)



Ward No. 7, Jugal Rural Municipality, Sindhupalchok: two room, stone and mud mortar masonry with an attic and CGI roofing. The home owner has received the second tranche of the GoN housing reconstruction grant and has been approved for the third tranche.

Case Studies

'Breaking gender stereotypes in construction work', Dev Kumari Thapa, Trained mason, Kamalamai Municipality, Sindhuli: I was living my life engaged in household chores and some farm work. I didn't have any skills to undertake a job. Also, my house was damaged by the earthquake. I heard about mason training opportunities in Sindhuli through the local radio and I thought it as a good chance for employment. I participated in a 50 days mason training supported by Swisscontact's Skills for Safe Reconstruction Project (SSRP), from June-August 2017. After completion of the training, I completed the skills test and was certified by the National Skill Testing Board. It was one of the happiest days of my life. Soon, I got to work as a mason with my other male colleagues on a nearby house. I am now recognised as a skilled mason and have a number of work opportunities. I have already constructed seven houses. I am very glad that I got this opportunity to live my life with a job and status. I would urge other women like me to grab this opportunity to improve their livelihood and become economically independent.



Dev Kumari Thapa pictured during the 50 day on the job training course that she completed in August 2017.

Case Study: Rasuwa, Gosaikunda RM, Ward No. 2, Timure



Left: the temporary shelter that Kami Sitar and Chirring Syangbo Tamang and their family have been living in since the April 2015 earthquake. Right: Mr. Kami Sitar Tamang.

Bishnu Kunwar, Ward no. 3, Bhanjyang, Dakshinkali, Kathmandu: Bishnu is a 71 year old single lady who never married. Bishnu's brick and mud mortar masonry, 2.5 storey house was severely damaged by the 2015 earthquake. She has not been able to remove the rubble since then. One small corner of this house has been used by her nephew's family as a kitchen, while Bishnu has been residing in a temporary shelter. Her nephew lives in another house nearby her temporary shelter. Bishnu has signed the Partnership Agreement (PA) with the government and received the first tranche of 50,000 NPRs. She spent part of the first tranche repaying loans she had taken to cover the costs of purchasing CGI sheets to build her temporary shelter. There is joint land ownership paper for the damaged house, but it belongs to her nephew. Because of the issues in land ownership, she has not been able to rebuild the house. She meets her daily requirements through the single women pension. Currently, she managed to buy 4 number of goats which she is raising. She suffers from asthma. Being a single woman, and a vulnerable earthquake affected beneficiary living in underprivileged condition, the Ward office of Ward no. 3, Bhanjyang reported this case to the HRRP Kathmandu Valley district coordination team. The ward office is appealing for support for Bishnu so that she can rebuild and move out of the temporary shelter. For more information please contact Mr. Karna Bahadur Shrestha, Acting Ward Chief, Ward no. 3, Bhanjyang, Dakshinkali Municipality, 9841540212, or Ms. Ambika Amatya, District Coordinator, Kathmandu Valley Team, HRRP, 9841356409, dc.ktm@hrrpnepal.org.



Left: Bishnu sits outside her damaged house. Right: uncleared rubble inside Bishnu's earthquake damaged house.

Rukmini Amatya, Ward no. 11, Talachhen Tole (Banglamukhi area), Lalitpur Metropolitan City, Lalitpur: Banglamukhi is located in the core heritage area of Lalitpur Metropolitan City. Rukmini 78 and her husband died 13 years ago and she receives the single woman pension from the government. She has 3 daughters who are all married and has 5 grandchildren. The house in Ward no. 11, Talachhen Tole is Rukmini's ancestral home and it is a traditional brick and mud mortar masonry house of 4.5 storeys. The rooms of her house are partitioned by interior walls of 16 inches and the floor mud with wooden stairs between the floors. Her daughters and their family members used to visit her regularly. She was forced to leave her house after the 2015 earthquake. Immediately after the earthquake she stayed in a temporary shelter with her relatives. After 4 days, she moved in with one of her daughters. Rukmini received relief support from government and has also signed a PA with the government in October 2016. Rukmini has been splitting her time between her daughters' homes and also sometimes staying with

her brother. She has not stayed in the house in Talachhen Tole since the earthquake. She cannot afford to demolish the house and does not have the capacity to rebuild. Because she is getting older her daughters do not want her to live alone and so she does not need to rebuild her house. Therefore, Rukmini returned the first tranche of the GoN housing reconstruction grant in January 2019.



Left: the front of Rukmini's earthquake damaged house. Middle: the back of Rukmini's earthquake damaged house. Right: Rukmini Amatya.

Featured Technical Staff Person, Binita Shrestha: Binita Shrestha, originally from Chitwan, was working as an architect in Bhaktapur Municipality before the April 2015 earthquake. In July 2016, Binita was hired by the NRA after applying for the role because she wanted to support the post-earthquake reconstruction. Binita was initially deployed to Chatrabaj VDC, now Namobuddha Municipality-9, in Kavre where she worked until the middle of July 2018. Binita was then transferred to Dhulikhel Municipality-9, Kavre, where she has been working since.

Both of the areas in Kavre where Binita has worked are VDCs that have been restructured into municipalities. The housing typologies of both areas are dominated by load bearing structures of brick and cement mortar masonry and stone and mud mortar masonry with very few RCC buildings. Compared to her previous posting in Namobuddha, the houses in Dhulikhel are more clustered which makes traveling between them for inspections and household visits a lot easier. Examples of the types of houses that Binita encounters in her work are shared in the photographs below.

Binita's main role is providing technical guidance to households and carrying out inspections as part of the housing reconstruction grant process. She also ensures all the inspected houses receive the tranches in a timely manner by visiting and regularly communicating with the DLPIUs. The training she received on ToT, Correction and Exception Manual, and Retrofitting has helped a lot. The ToT has helped her understand the technical aspects of construction and building codes and the training on the Correction and Exceptions Manual has helped her to be able to suggest the correction measures for non-compliances. Because retrofitting is a very complex process, she has not been able to deliver the learnings from the training to the beneficiaries.

The Ward Chief in Dhulikhel Municipality-9 shared that Binita's positivity and commitment for her work is reflected in the tranche progress of the ward. Eight months before, the overall reconstruction progress was 35% whereas now it is 60%. Binita feels that the positive working environment of the ward office and support from households is what has contributed to the improvements in the tranche disbursement figures. Binita shared that households and masons have been very receptive to advice she has provided and constructed accordingly. Her first field experience was an inspection of a brick and cement mortar masonry house which was being constructed by a group of untrained masons. Binita found that the masons were laying the steel in the plinth beam with two rods tied twelve

inches apart and explained that the standards require four rods tied at four inch intervals. The masons took on board the advice and replicated it in every construction thereafter.

Binita feels that it is very positive to see the gradual move from temporary shelters into safer permanent houses but also fears that in the name of safer construction, the traditional architecture and technology will be lost. She feels that the policies/guidelines developed by NRA to support reconstruction, awareness programmes, mason trainings, and mobilisation of technical staff have helped to achieve such an impact on safer construction but insufficient skilled labour and less manpower at DLPIUs pose challenges to the reconstruction progress.







Requests for Partner Support

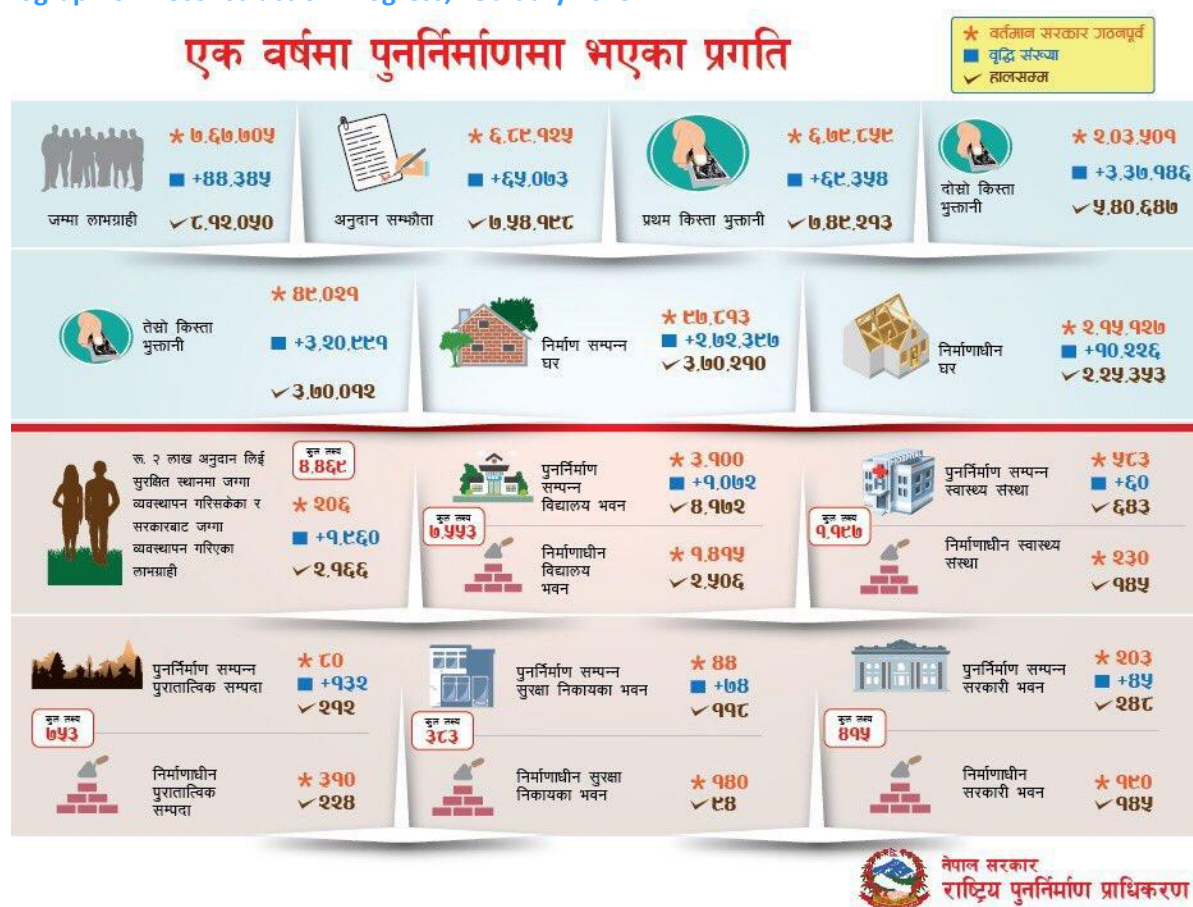
[Round Table Discussion on Support to Vulnerable Households, 19 February, 1-4 PM, Bougainville, Tripureshor:](#) please join us for this event where the HRRP's Vulnerable Support Working Group (VSWG), co-chaired by DFID and SDC, will share the group's work to date. This will include findings, challenges, issues, lessons learned, and advocacy points which will be discussed, and if appropriate, endorsed by partners during the round table discussion.

GoN Products

[Causes Behind Delays in Housing Reconstruction Progress in the Earthquake Housing Reconstruction Programme \(EHRP\), A Study of Rural Municipalities of Lalitpur, NRA Monitoring and Evaluation Specialist for Lalitpur, Okhaldhunga, and Rasuwa:](#) the study area was Mahankal, Konjyom, and Bagmati rural municipalities in Lalitpur and main objective of the study was to find out the causes behind delays in housing reconstruction progress in rural areas of Lalitpur district. The study specifically focused on looking into the reasons why some households have not started to rebuild their house, what factors are affecting the rate of disbursement of the second and third tranches of the housing reconstruction grant and gathering more information on households' plans for the reconstruction of a new earthquake resistant house. The report makes five recommendations based on the study findings. These include increasing presence of social mobilisers and technical staff at household / field level and providing training to field staff on the corrections and exceptions manual, implementation of corrections, and how to communicate the corrections process to households. For more information please contact Yam Nath Giri, Monitoring and Evaluation Specialist, National Reconstruction Authority, District Level Project Implementation Unit (Grant Management and Local infrastructure), Lalitpur, Rasuwa and Okhaldhunga, Phone: 01-5544379, Mobile No: 9851239785, email: yamnathgiri2014@gmail.com, yamnathgiri2009@yahoo.com.

[Revisions to the Grant Disbursement Procedures for Private Houses Destroyed by the Earthquake, Nepali and Unofficial English Translation](#)

NRA Infograph on Reconstruction Progress, February 2019



HRRP Products

5W Products are prepared based on the [latest round of 5W data, as of 25 December 2018](#). **Housing reconstruction progress maps** are prepared based on Building CLPIU data as of 5 February 2019.



Technical Assistance for Housing Reconstruction - Coverage of Activities

[7 TA Activities-32 districts](#)
[7 TA Activities - Eastern Cluster](#)
[7 TA Activities - Central Cluster](#)
[7 TA Activities - Western Cluster](#)
[Short Training Coverage](#)
[Vocational Training Coverage](#)
[Community & HHs Orientation](#)
[Demonstration Construction](#)
[Door to Door Technical Assistance Helpdesks/Tech. Resource Centres](#)



Sector Wise Maps of EQ affected districts

[Agriculture, Livestock Dev, Irrigation](#)
[Disaster Risk Management](#)
[Education](#)
[Employment and Livelihood](#)
[Gender Equality and Social Inclusion](#)
[Health](#)
[Nutrition](#)
[Social Protection](#)
[Water, Sanitation, and Hygiene](#)
[Number of POs in each ward](#)
[Number of sectors in each ward](#)



Housing Reconstruction Progress Maps

[PA agreement between HHs and GoN, Nepali Version](#)
[Construction Started, Nepali Version](#)
[1st tranche received, Nepali Version](#)
[Compliance rate 2nd tranche, Nepali Version](#)
[Compliance rate 3rd tranche, Nepali Version](#)
[Construction completed, Nepali Version](#)

Partner Products

[ASF Nepal Newsletter, Edition No. 25, December 2018](#)

Milijuli Nepali, Episode 1188: this episode was recorded in Bhimfedi, Makwanpur district. Keshav Narayan Mulmi shares the history of Bhimphedi rural municipality and guides the presenter, Prakash Sundas, through the rural municipality. The first house they visit is of Ganga Devi Amatya, who shows them around her traditional house that has cracks due to the earthquake, but she does not want to demolish it. Keshav Narayan suggests that Ganga should visit the ward office to get suggestions and guidance on options for retrofit. Ganga shares that she does not know anything about retrofitting. The second story is of Bishnu Devi Pariyar, who is a tailor. She shares her livelihood activities. She also shares the differences between tailoring costs before and now. The final story is of Madav Das Shrestha who shares that his house is more than 100 years old and says that they have maintained the house time and again to make it strong. At last Keshav Narayan shares that the houses in the rural municipality have proper foundation, small, attached to one another and have tie beams which has helped the houses to withstand the earthquake.

Baliyo Ghar TV, Episode 131: this episode is focused on the Management Information System used for the overall reconstruction in Nepal. The episode discusses areas such as archiving of information, access to the MIS and the data held there, and how data is collected and managed. The programme includes interviews with Mr. Dhundiraj Lamichhane, Director, Central Bureau of Statistics, Mr. Manohar Ghimire, NRA Vice-Spokesperson, Mr. Ishwor Man Dangol, Ward chair of KTM Metropolitan City-15, Mr. Ram Yadav, NRA MIS Specialist, and our own Mr. Uttam Poudel, HRRP Information Management Manager.

UK Shelter Forum 23, Notes and Presentations: the event was held on 23 November 2018 and featured a panel discussion with representation of the Nepal recovery at the event and via video conference from Kathmandu. You can view the NRA CEO's address to the forum [here](#).

[FAQs](#) | [Briefing Pack](#) | [Meeting & Events](#) | [5W](#) | [Housing Progress](#) | [Housing Typologies](#)



CONTACT US

HRRP Nepal Office

Jawagal, Lalitpur, Nepal

Tel: (+977) - 01 - 5544149

Email: info@hrrpnepal.org